Disabling index auto-creation

By default, Elasticsearch auto-creates a required index if the index doesn't already exist. If we want to restrict this feature, we need to set a flag called `action.auto_create_index` to `false`. This can be done two ways:

- Set the flag to `false` in the elasticsearch.yml config file.
- Explicitly set the flag by invoking the `_cluster/settings` endpoint:

```
PUT _cluster/settings
{
  "persistent": {
    "action.auto_create_index": "false"
  }
}
```

For example, the call `PUT my_new_index/_doc/1` fails if `action.auto_create_index` is set to `false`. You may want to do this if you have already created the index manually (most likely with predefined settings and mapping schema) and don't need to allow the creation of indexes on demand. We talk more about indexing operations in the next section.

Now that we understand how documents are persisted, let's examine the mechanics of how Elasticsearch stores them. The next section focuses on how the indexing process works.

5.1.2 Mechanics of indexing

We briefly looked at how indexing works in section 3.2.3. In this section, we go over the mechanics involved when a document is indexed (see figure 5.4). As we already

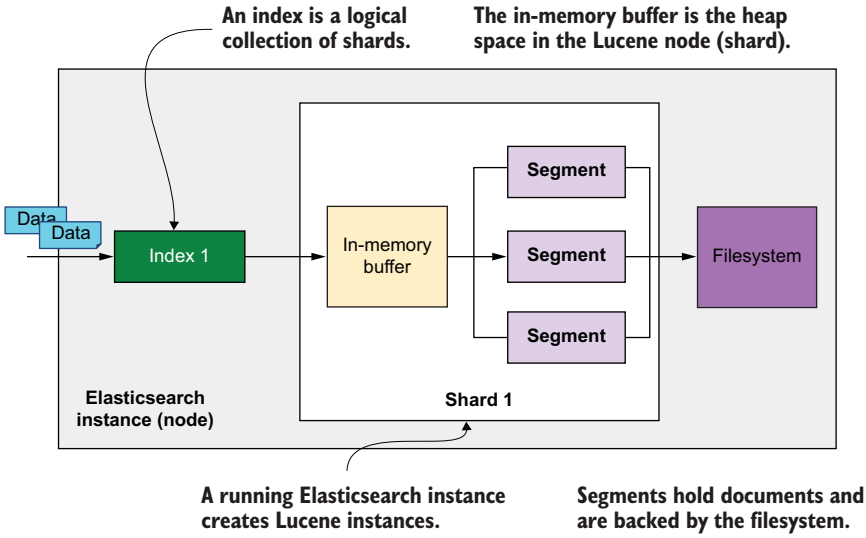


Figure 5.4 Mechanics of indexing documents